

AdvocateAuroraHealth

Title: AAH HIT Logging & Retention Standard		Document Number:
Document Type: ☐ Policy ☐ Procedure ☐ Guideline ☒ Other Standard		Last Review/Revision Date:
Content Applies to Patient Care: (Select all that apply) ☐ Adults ☐ Pediatrics (Under 18)	Content Applies to: (Select One) ☐ Clinical ☒ Administrative	Next Review Date:
		Effective Date:
Scope: ☐ AAH System ☐ ACH ☐ AAH IL Only ☐ AAH WI Only ☐ Site Only (Location Name): ☒ Department Only (Department Name): HIT		

I. PURPOSE

Advocate Aurora Health (AAH) HIT retains logs for business purposes to meet minimal contractual, fiscal, and regulatory requirements. This standard defines the strategy for HIT to perform logging and retention activities.

II. SCOPE

This standard applies to AAH HIT team members and all logging related activities performed within HIT.

III. DEFINITIONS/ABBREVIATIONS

Advocate Aurora Information: All information that is owned by Advocate Aurora or owned by vendors, subcontractors, and/or business associates but provided to Advocate Aurora. For clarification purposes only, information remains "Advocate Aurora Information" even if it is in the possession and under the control of a vendor, subcontractor, and/or business associate.

Audit Log: The raw data that is created to maintain a record of AAH information technology systems. Audit Logs are records indicating the sequence of activities or a specific activity that occurred during any event such as a log-in or an action taken within an information system.

Endpoint Device- an Internet-capable computer hardware device on a TCP/IP network. The term can refer to desktop computers, laptops, smart phones, tablets, thin clients, printers or other specialized hardware such as sensors, actuators, and point of sale (POS) terminals.

Health Information Technology – HIT

High Risk Hardware – Inclusive of: Desktops, mobile devices, network equipment, storage equipment, servers, firewalls, printers, encrypted flash drives, hard drives, and with data stored containing Information Classification 3 or 4 as defined in the AAH Information Classification Policy.

Information Classification – See Information Classification Policy

Information System Activity Report: A report or audit run using data such as Audit Logs to identify system activity (e.g., logins, file access, and security incidents).

Low Risk Hardware - Inclusive of: Accessories, cables, carts, batteries & power cords, monitors, digital sign tracking boards, laptop mounts, keyboards, medical imaging graphic cards, phones, headsets, webcams, and mounts.

Protected Health Information (“PHI”): The term shall have the same meaning as the term is defined in HIPAA and defined in the AAH Information Classifications Policy.

Regulated Data: Any data or information that is regulated by federal or state government. Regulated Data includes, without limitation, PHI, personal information (as defined under applicable law), and credit card data.

Software: Computer programs (code), procedures, documentation and data pertaining to the operation of a computer system. For this standard, “software” refers to all software which accesses or is used to access Advocate Aurora Information and Information Resources.

Solution: Any combination of software, hardware and information which addresses a defined use case or business need.

IV. Standard

A. AAH HIT Logging and Retention Requirements

1. HIT will retain audit logs and/or info system activity reports for solutions per contractual requirements.
2. If there is an AAH Policy or AAH HIT Standard defining audit log or information system activity report retention requirements, the solution should follow the logging and retention requirements defined in that policy or standard (see cross references).
3. If the solution contains Information Classification 4 (Legally Restricted Confidential Information) or 3 (AAH Restricted Access Confidential Information) and is not included in statement IV.A.1. or 2, then it should be retained for no more than
 - a) Audit Logs - 12 months

- b) Information System Activity Report 6 years (Classification 4)
 - c) Information System Activity Report 2 years (Classification 3)
 - 4. If the solution contains Information Classification 2 (AAH Internal Confidential Information) or Information Classification 1 (Public Information) and is not included in statement IV.A.1. or 2, then it should be retained for no more than 6 months.
 - a) Audit Logs - 90 days
 - b) Information System Activity Report - 6 months
- B. Legal/Litigation Hold
 - 1. HIT must follow all Legal/Litigation Hold policies and procedures for audit logging and Information System Activity Report retention.

V. Roles and Responsibilities

n/a

VI. CROSS REFERENCES

AAH Record Retention Storage and Destruction Policy and Appendix A
AAH Electronic Communications Use and Retention
AAH Network Security
AAH Server Security Integrated
AAH HIT Change Management Standard

VII. RESOURCES AND REFERENCES

Memorandum to Privacy Officers – re Retention of Audit Logs

VIII. ATTACHMENTS

N/A